

ROWAN TODAY

Field Guide for Mom

Version 3.0

Take a breath—this isn't another job to do.

This guide is meant to make today a little easier, not perfect. You don't need to teach a lesson, correct every answer, or keep Rowan's attention for a long time. Think of yourself as his teammate in a game of solving little mysteries.

Start with something he already loves. Monster trucks. Chess. Food. Those aren't distractions—they're the doorway in. When he's interested, he's more likely to think, explain, and stay engaged.

Today's goal is simply this:

Enjoy a few minutes together while helping Rowan notice clues, think of more than one possibility, and explain his reasoning.

■ BEFORE YOU START

What do I say?

'Chief Investigator, we've got a new case. Which mission do you want today? Monster Trucks, Chess, or Food?'

What am I looking for?

Interest. Curiosity. A smile. Choosing is already participation.

If he's not interested?

Let him pick a different theme or try again later.

■ MONSTER TRUCK CASE

Say:

'Grave Digger has muddy tires. Bigfoot is upside down. The orange ramp moved. What do you think happened?'

Ask next:

- What clue helped you?
- Could something else have happened?
- What clue would settle the mystery?

Praise:

'I like how you looked for clues.'

■■ CHESS OR ■ FOOD

Chess:

'One piece is secretly threatening another. Which one is your first suspect?'

Food:

'Someone ate the last snack. Before we decide who did it, what clues should we look for?'

If he surprises you:

Ask, 'Tell me more.'

■ IF THINGS GO SIDEWAYS

If he argues:

Don't argue back. Stay curious: 'Interesting...what makes you think that?'

If he loses focus:

End the mystery. Success is a positive interaction, not finishing the page.

End with:

'I had fun solving that with you. Let's do another case another day.'

ONE-PAGE POCKET REMINDER

Remember:

- Connection before correction.
- Questions before explanations.
- Praise thinking, not perfection.
- Follow his interests.
- Stop while it's still fun.

If today's only victory is that Rowan enjoyed thinking with you for five minutes, that's a real win.